Nature Walks & Scouting

Alveary

About the Course

Students spend time once each week on a longer excursion. Prompts can be found in Outdoor Work, if desired. This digital resource is provided with all science lessons.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Science: Grade 1, Science: Grade 2, Science: Grade 3, Science: Grade 4, Science: Grade 5, Science: Grade 6, Science: Grade 7, Science: Grade 8

About Science: Grade 1
In Level 1, learners are developing familiarity and friendship with Creation through the most accessible Things, simple text, and basic concepts.

About Science: Grade 2
In level 2, learners are developing familiarity and friendship with Creation through a broader scope of Things, more challenging text, and slightly more abstract concepts.

About Science: Grade 3
In level 3, learners are developing familiarity and friendship with Creation through a broader scope of Things, more challenging text, and more abstract concepts.

About Science: Grade 4
In level 4, learners begin to notice science in their community and begin to develop their own interests as they discover a variety of topics from the microscopic world, physical science, and more. A mixture of more and less challenging books is included in this course.

About Science: Grade 5
In level 5, learners expand their knowledge of science in their world and continue building personal connections as they discover a variety of topics from botany, astronomy, and more.

About Science: Grade 6
In level 6, learners expand their knowledge of science in their world and continue building personal connections as they discover a variety of topics from oceanography, architecture, and more. Reading level and time required are transitional as we gently prepare for the middle grades.

About Science: Grade 7
In level 7, learners extend their relationship with science in a new direction (time), situating science in its historical, political, and cultural context, and beginning to understand that science is an ever-changing process rather than a static body of knowledge. Reading level and expectation increase from previous levels.

About Science: Grade 8
In level 8, learners study science in its historical, political, and cultural context, and with a growing understanding that science is an ever-changing process rather than a static body of knowledge. Reading level and expectation increase from previous levels.

Science: Grade 1
The Big Picture:
To accomplish the goal of supporting a relationship with the Things of the Universe, a Mason science program consists of nature lore, natural history, and general science. Nature immersion, inquiry, community connection, and supportive literature are woven into each of these three parts. Form 1 learners in Grades 1-3 are at the beginning of this relationship: developing familiarity and friendship with Creation. Their sense of community is primarily focused on their immediate environment at this stage, but they are curious about others. The familiarity with foundational knowledge grown and nurtured in Form 1 prepares them for greater curiosity and personal interest in Form 2.

Nature lore is timeless knowledge that is passed through a community, much like a grandmother passes on how to make that special bread when the dough just 'feels right.' Like Mason, we strive to pass on this knowledge primarily through outdoor work. Group nature walks, seasonal readings, and topics in scouting are provided as an Outdoor Work resource in the Quick Links. If desired, literature suggestions to support lore can be found in the Community Read Alouds resource (in Literature Grades 1-3).

Science: Grade 2
The Big Picture:
To accomplish the goal of supporting a relationship with the Things of the Universe, a Mason science program consists of nature lore, natural history, and general science. Nature immersion, inquiry, community connection, and supportive literature are woven into each of these three parts. Form 1 learners in grades 1-3 are at the beginning of this relationship: developing familiarity and friendship with Creation. Their sense of community is primarily focused on their immediate environment at this stage, but they are curious about others. The familiarity with foundational knowledge grown and nurtured in Form 1 prepares them for greater curiosity and personal interest in Form 2.

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Science: Grade 3
The Big Picture:
To accomplish the goal of supporting a relationship with the Things of the Universe, a Mason science program consists of nature lore, natural history, and general science. Nature immersion, inquiry, community connection, and supportive literature are woven into each of these three parts. Form 1 learners in grades 1-3 are at the beginning of this relationship: developing familiarity and friendship with Creation. Their sense of community is primarily focused on their immediate environment at this stage, but they are curious about others. The familiarity with foundational knowledge grown and nurtured in Form 1 prepares them for greater curiosity and personal interest in Form 2.

Nature lore is timeless knowledge that is passed through a community, much like a grandmother passes on how to make that special bread when the dough just "feels right." Like Mason, we strive to pass on this knowledge primarily through outdoor work. Group nature walks, seasonal readings, and topics in scouting are provided as an Outdoor Work resource in the Quick Links. If desired, literature suggestions to support lore can be found in the Community Read Alouds resource (in Literature Grades 1-3).

Science: Grade 4
The Big Picture:
To accomplish the goal of supporting a relationship with the Things of the Universe, a Mason science program consists of nature lore, natural history, and general science. Nature immersion, inquiry, community connection, and supportive literature are woven into each of these three parts. Building on the familiarity and foundational knowledge of Form 1, Form 2 learners in grades 4-6 extend the scope of the Things they encounter and begin to notice that science is active in their world. Growing in their self-knowledge at this age, they may notice that they gravitate toward some of these Things more than others. This is a bit like noticing that you have a natural rapport with a particular friend because they seem to understand the way you think and share the same interests. This is wonderful and very typical, but we still want them to get to know more “friends” in science and try different Things, even though one might be their particular interest. Their sense of community is expanding, as well: who are the scientists in their world, and what are they doing? Special care has been taken to build vocabulary and conceptual knowledge “by the way” and to maintain the connection between scientific endeavors and the human experience. In Form 3, students will continue to build on this knowledge of what science is doing in the world when they examine science in its historical context.

Nature lore is timeless knowledge that is passed through a community, much like a grandmother passes on how to make that special bread when the dough just "feels right." Like Mason, we strive to pass on this knowledge primarily through outdoor work. Group nature walks, seasonal readings, and topics in scouting are provided as an Outdoor Work resource in the Quick Links. If desired, literature suggestions to support lore can be found in the Community Read Alouds resource (in Citizenship Grades 4+).

Science: Grade 5

The Big Picture:
To accomplish the goal of supporting a relationship with the Things of the Universe, a Mason science program consists of nature lore, natural history, and general science. Nature immersion, inquiry, community connection, and supportive literature are woven into each of these three parts. Building on the familiarity and foundational knowledge of Form 1, Form 2 learners in grades 4-6 extend the scope of the Things they encounter and begin to notice that science is active in their world. Growing in their self-knowledge at this age, they may notice that they gravitate toward some of these Things more than others. This is a bit like noticing that you have a natural rapport with a particular friend because they seem to understand the way you think and share the same interests. This is wonderful and very typical, but we still want them to get to know more “friends” in science and try different Things, even though one might be their particular interest. Their sense of community is expanding, as well: who are the scientists in their world, and what are they doing? Special care has been taken to build vocabulary and conceptual knowledge “by the way” and to maintain the connection between scientific endeavors and the human experience. In Form 3, students will continue to build on this knowledge of what science is doing in the world when they examine science in its historical context.

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Science: Grade 6
The Big Picture:
To accomplish the goal of supporting a relationship with the Things of the Universe, a Mason science program consists of nature lore, natural history, and general science. Nature immersion, inquiry, community connection, and supportive literature are woven into each of these three parts. Building on the familiarity and foundational knowledge of Form 1, Form 2 learners in grades 4-6 extend the scope of the Things they encounter and begin to notice that science is active in their world. Growing in their self-knowledge at this age, they may notice that they gravitate toward some of these Things more than others. This is a bit like noticing that you have a natural rapport with a particular friend because they seem to understand the way you think and share the same interests. This is wonderful and very typical, but we still want them to get to know more “friends” in science and try different Things, even though one might be their particular interest. Their sense of community is expanding, as well: who are the scientists in their world, and what are they doing? Special care has been taken to build vocabulary and conceptual knowledge “by the way” and to maintain the connection between scientific endeavors and the human experience. In Form 3, students will continue to build on this knowledge of what science is doing in the world when they examine science in its historical context.

Nature lore is timeless knowledge that is passed through a community, much like a grandmother passes on how to make that special bread when the dough just "feels right." Like Mason, we strive to pass on this knowledge primarily through outdoor work. Group nature walks, seasonal readings, and topics in scouting are provided as an Outdoor Work resource in the Quick Links. If desired, literature suggestions to support lore can be found in the Community Read Alouds resource (in Citizenship Grades 4+).

Science: Grade 7
The Big Picture:
To accomplish the goal of supporting a relationship with the Things of the Universe, a Mason science program consists of nature lore, natural history, and general science. Nature immersion, inquiry, community connection, and supportive literature are woven into each of these three parts. In Form 1, students became acquainted with this area of knowledge, science. Form 2 students extended their scope and began to encounter science as an active part of society. Form 3 students extend their relationship with science in a new direction (time) and consider science as a process by which man seeks Truth within Creation. They begin to situate science in its historical, political, and cultural context with all of the complexities of man's own story. In this way, students are prepared to think about science with a complete and holistic perspective.

Nature lore is timeless knowledge that is passed through a community, much like a grandmother passes on how to make that special bread when the dough just "feels right." Like Mason, we strive to pass on this knowledge primarily through outdoor work. Group nature walks, seasonal readings, and topics in scouting are provided as an Outdoor Work resource in the Quick Links. If desired, literature suggestions to support lore can be found in the

Community Read Alouds resource (in Citizenship Grades 4+).

Science: Grade 8
The Big Picture:
To accomplish the goal of supporting a relationship with the Things of the Universe, a Mason science program consists of nature lore, natural history, and general science. Nature immersion, inquiry, community connection, and supportive literature are woven into each of these three parts. In Form 1, students became acquainted with this area of knowledge, science. Form 2 students extended their scope and began to encounter science as an active part of society. Form 3 students extend their relationship with science in a new direction (time) and consider science as a process by which man seeks Truth within Creation. They begin to situate science in its historical, political, and cultural context with all of the complexities of man's own story. In this way, students are prepared to think about science with a complete and holistic perspective.

Nature lore is timeless knowledge that is passed through a community, much like a grandmother passes on how to make that special bread when the dough just "feels right." Like Mason, we strive to pass on this knowledge primarily through outdoor work. Group nature walks, seasonal readings, and topics in scouting are provided as an Outdoor Work resource in the Quick Links. If desired, literature suggestions to support lore can be found in the Community Read Alouds resource (in Citizenship Grades 4+).

Placement & Combining Tips

About Science: Grade 1
In Level 1, learners are developing familiarity and friendship with Creation through the most accessible Things, simple text, and basic concepts.

About Science: Grade 2
In level 2, learners are developing familiarity and friendship with Creation through a broader scope of Things, more challenging text, and slightly more abstract concepts.

About Science: Grade 3
In level 3, learners are developing familiarity and friendship with Creation through a broader scope of Things, more challenging text, and more abstract concepts.

About Science: Grade 4
In level 4, learners begin to notice science in their community and begin to develop their own interests as they discover a variety of topics from the microscopic world, physical science, and more. A mixture of more and less challenging books is included in this course.

About Science: Grade 5
In level 5, learners expand their knowledge of science in their world and continue building personal connections as they discover a variety of topics from botany, astronomy, and more.

About Science: Grade 6
In level 6, learners expand their knowledge of science in their world and continue building personal connections as they discover a variety of topics from oceanography, architecture, and more. Reading level, historical context, and time required are transitional as we gently prepare for the middle grades.

About Science: Grade 7
In level 7, learners extend their relationship with science in a new direction (time), situating science in its historical, political, and cultural context, and begin to understand that science is an ever-changing process rather than a static body of knowledge. Reading level and expectations increase from previous levels.

About Science: Grade 8
In level 8, learners study science in its historical, political, and cultural context with a growing understanding that science is an ever-changing process rather than a static body of knowledge. Reading level and expectations increase from previous levels.

Nature Walks & Scouting: Grades 1-8
Learners may be combined and share prompts or follow the plan of their local scouting troop or natural history club. Support accessibility and sensory development as appropriate.

Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
1-8	Nature Walks & Scouting: Grades 1-8 1 time/week 30 min+	

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Science: Grade 1				
Natural History: Grade 1 Nature Walks & Scouting: Grades 1-8	Nature Notebook: Grade 1		General Science: Grade 1	
Science: Grade 2				
General Science: Grade 2 Nature Notebook: Grade 2		Natural History: Grade 2 Nature Walks & Scouting: Grades 1-8		
Science: Grade 3				
General Science: Grade 3 Nature Walks & Scouting: Grades 1-8	Nature Notebook: Grade 3	Natural History: Grade 3		
Science: Grade 4				
Natural History: Grade 4		General Science: Grade 4 Nature Walks & Scouting: Grades 1-8		Labs: Grade 4 Nature Notebook: Grade 4
Science: Grade 5				
Natural History: Grade 5		General Science: Grade 5 Nature Walks & Scouting: Grades 1-8		Labs: Grade 5 Nature Notebook: Grade 5
Science: Grade 6				
Natural History: Grade 6		General Science: Grade 6 Nature Walks & Scouting: Grades 1-8	General Science: Grade 6 Nature Notebook: Grade 6	Labs: Grade 6
Science: Grade 7				
Natural History: Grade 7	General Science: Grade 7	General Science: Grade 7	Nature Notebook: Grade 7	Labs: Grade 7 Nature Walks & Scouting: Grades 1-8
Science: Grade 8				
Natural History: Grade 8	General Science: Grade 8 Nature Walks & Scouting: Grades 1-8	General Science: Grade 8	General Science: Grade 8 Nature Notebook: Grade 8	Labs: Grade 8

Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Science: Grade 1
☐ Obtain any supplies indicated on the science or grade-level supply lists.
☐ Download any apps and shortcut any desired links.

Nature Lore:
☐ Bookmark your Outdoor Work Quick Link, so that you have it available on your weekly

outing. Outdoor Work is generally flexible for your location and season and can be moved around in the schedule to incorporate or substitute Natural History Club outings.
☐ Print or bookmark grade-specific nature notebook suggestions to support natural history and general science. Notebooking can be done on a walk, during occupations, or as a field trip, as appropriate.

Science: Grade 2
☐ Obtain any supplies indicated on the science or grade-level supply lists.
☐ Download any apps and shortcut any desired links.

Nature Lore:
☐ Bookmark your Outdoor Work Quick Link, so that you have it available on your weekly outing. Outdoor Work is generally flexible for your location and season and can be moved around in the schedule to incorporate or substitute Natural History Club outings.
☐ Print or bookmark grade-specific nature notebook suggestions to support natural history and general science. Notebooking can be done on a walk, during occupations, or as a field trip, as appropriate.

Science: Grade 3
☐ Obtain any supplies indicated on the science or grade-level supply lists.
☐ Download any apps and shortcut any desired links.

Nature Lore:
☐ Bookmark your Outdoor Work Quick Link, so that you have it available on your weekly outing. Outdoor Work is generally flexible for your location and season and can be moved around in the schedule to incorporate or substitute Natural History Club outings.
☐ Print or bookmark grade-specific nature notebook suggestions to support natural history and general science. Notebooking can be done on a walk, during occupations, or as a field trip, as appropriate.

Science: Grade 4
☐ Obtain any supplies indicated on the science or grade-level supply lists.
☐ Download any apps and shortcut any desired links.

Nature Lore:
☐ Bookmark your Outdoor Work Quick Link, so that you have it available on your weekly outing. Outdoor Work is generally flexible for your location and season and can be moved around in the schedule to incorporate or substitute Natural History Club outings.
☐ Print or bookmark grade-specific nature notebook suggestions to support natural history and general science. Notebooking can be done on a walk, during occupations, or as a field trip, as appropriate.

Science: Grade 5
☐ Obtain any supplies indicated on the science or grade-level supply lists.
☐ Download any apps and shortcut any desired links.

Nature Lore:
☐ Bookmark your Outdoor Work Quick Link, so that you have it available on your weekly outing. Outdoor Work is generally flexible for your location and season and can be moved around in the schedule to incorporate or substitute Natural History Club outings.
☐ Print or bookmark grade-specific nature notebook suggestions to support natural history and general science. Notebooking can be done on a walk, during occupations, or as a field trip, as appropriate.

Science: Grade 6
☐ Obtain any supplies indicated on the science or grade-level supply lists.
☐ Download any apps and shortcut any desired links.

Nature Lore:
☐ Bookmark your Outdoor Work Quick Link, so that you have it available on your weekly outing. Outdoor Work is generally flexible for your location and season and can be moved around in the schedule to incorporate or substitute Natural History Club outings.
☐ Print or bookmark grade-specific nature notebook suggestions to support natural history and general science. Notebooking can be done on a walk, during occupations, or as a field trip, as appropriate.

Science: Grade 7
☐ Obtain any supplies indicated on the science or grade-level supply lists.
☐ Download any apps and shortcut any desired links.

Nature Lore:
☐ Bookmark your Outdoor Work Quick Link, so that you have it available on your weekly outing. Outdoor Work is generally flexible for your location and season and can be moved around in the schedule to incorporate or substitute Natural History Club outings, except where the suggestion is to collect some Thing for a lesson.
☐ Print or bookmark grade-specific nature notebook suggestions to support natural history and general science. Notebooking can be done on a walk, during occupations, or as a field trip, as appropriate.

Science: Grade 8
☐ Obtain any supplies indicated on the science or grade-level supply lists.
☐ Download any apps and shortcut any desired links.

Nature Lore:
☐ Bookmark your Outdoor Work Quick Link, so that you have it available on your weekly outing. Outdoor Work is generally flexible for your location and season and can be moved around in the schedule to incorporate or substitute Natural History Club outings, except where the suggestion is to collect some Thing for a lesson.
☐ Print or bookmark grade-specific nature notebook suggestions to support natural history and general science. Notebooking can be done on a walk, during occupations, or as a field trip, as appropriate.

Special Topics & Field Trips

Science: Grade 1
☐ Learn a few of your local species on these special topics using the internet, field guides, or your local nature preserve, conservancy, or state/national park.
☐ Note whether there are particular locations nearby for the student to easily notice the special topics on walks or during afternoon occupations.

Science: Grade 2
☐ Learn a few of your local species on these special topics using the internet, field guides, or your local nature preserve, conservancy, or state/national park.
☐ Note whether there are particular locations nearby for the student to easily notice the special topics on walks or during afternoon occupations.

Science: Grade 3
☐ Learn a few of your local species on these special topics using the internet, field guides, or your local nature preserve, conservancy, or state/national park.
☐ Note whether there are particular locations nearby for the student to easily notice the special topics on walks or during afternoon occupations.

Science: Grade 4
Encourage students to begin choosing their own special topic to observe, study, and research in their field guides. What or who are they curious about or interested in getting to know better? Teachers can choose their own special study, too! Suggested field trips include:

Science: Grade 5
Encourage students to begin choosing their own special topic to observe, study, and research in their field guides. What or who are they curious about or interested in getting to know better? Teachers can choose their own special study, too! Suggested field trips include:

Science: Grade 6
Encourage students to begin choosing their own special topic to observe, study, and research in their field guides. What or who are they curious about or interested in getting to know better? Teachers can choose their own special study, too! Suggested field trips include:

Science: Grade 7
Encourage students to choose their own special topic and to notice its ecological relationships. What or who are they curious about or interested in getting to know better? Teachers can choose their own special study, too!

☐ Learn a few of your local species or varieties in connection with special topics.

Science: Grade 8
Encourage students to choose their own special topic and to notice its ecological relationships. What or who are they curious about or interested in getting to know better? Teachers can choose their own special study, too!

☐ Learn a few of your local species or varieties in connection with special topics.

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

Science: Grade 1
Object lesson prompts are woven into the lessons as appropriate, but teachers are encouraged to read corresponding Handbook of Nature Study (HoNS) selections each term:

Science: Grade 2
Object lesson prompts are woven into the lessons, as appropriate, but teachers are encouraged to read corresponding Handbook of Nature Study (HoNS) selections each term:

Science: Grade 3
Object lesson prompts are woven into the lessons, as appropriate, but teachers are encouraged to read corresponding Handbook of Nature Study (HoNS) selections each term:

Science: Grade 4
Object lesson prompts are woven into the lessons, as appropriate, but teachers are encouraged to read corresponding Handbook of Nature Study (HoNS) selections each term and/or any that support special topics chosen by students:

Science: Grade 5
Object lesson prompts are woven into the lessons, as appropriate, but teachers are encouraged to read corresponding Handbook of Nature Study (HoNS) selections each term and/or any that support special topics chosen by students:

Science: Grade 6
Object lesson prompts are woven into the lessons, as appropriate, but teachers are encouraged to read corresponding Handbook of Nature Study (HoNS) selections each term and/or any that support special topics chosen by students:

Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

- View Basic Supplies
- View Supply List Details

Nature Walks & Scouting: Grades 1-8

 Wild Bird Seed

 Bird Feeder

 Hand Lens

 Small Collection Containers

 Small Basin

 Dip Net

 Student Microscope

Quick Links

Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.

Related Course Quick Links

- Outdoor Work
- Microscope Coloring Book
- Seek app from iNaturalist

- SkyView Lite for iOS
- SkyView Lite for Android
- Alternate One Year Physical Science Lesson Plans
- Foundations (See Section 13: Science)